

Darkening

Hana Blaha Šilarová
Frame Films
Prague, Czech Republic
h.silarova@seznam.cz



ABSTRACT

How is the world perceived by someone with depression? The animated immersive film uses virtual reality to address depression and the ways to cope with it. Director and protagonist Ondřej guides us through diverse landscapes associating the story of his struggle with depression since puberty. We share his feelings during the first depressive episodes at a family trip in his childhood, at university when striving for perfect results, at work in his everyday fights with the depressive ‘darkening’. Through animation, combining a

stylised form of Ondřej’s environment and abstract images of his emotions, the viewers will experience and understand what it is like to live with this illness, how to tackle it and what mechanisms are used by people with depression to feel better. Most of the interactions are voice controlled. The main character Ondřej finds out that his tool to get the depression under control is his voice. He uses humming, singing and even shouting as a calming and relieving technique.

ACM Reference Format:

Hana Blaha Šilarová. 2023. Darkening. In *SIGGRAPH Asia 2023 XR (SA XR '23), December 12–15, 2023, Sydney, NSW, Australia*. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 1 page. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3610549.3614595>

Permission to make digital or hard copies of part or all of this work for personal or classroom use is granted without fee provided that copies are not made or distributed for profit or commercial advantage and that copies bear this notice and the full citation on the first page. Copyrights for third-party components of this work must be honored. For all other uses, contact the owner/author(s).

SA XR '23, December 12–15, 2023, Sydney, NSW, Australia

© 2023 Copyright held by the owner/author(s).

ACM ISBN 979-8-4007-0316-4/23/12.

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3610549.3614595>